

1. Which of the following are the three most common methods for organizing websites?

- **Answer:** b. hierarchical, linear, and random
- *Explanation:* Websites are primarily structured using a hierarchical layout (top-down menu), a linear layout (sequential steps, like a checkout process), or a random/webbed layout (interlinked pages with no rigid structure).

2. Which of the following are the four principles of the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines?

- **Answer:** b. perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust
- *Explanation:* Often abbreviated as **POUR**, these four principles form the foundation of web accessibility (WCAG), ensuring that users with disabilities can interact with web content.

3. Which of the following are influenced by the intended or target audience of a site?

- **Answer:** d. all of the above
- *Explanation:* The demographics, age group, and professional background of the target audience dictate every aspect of design, including color vibrance, font sizing for readability, and the overall look and feel.

4. Which of the following recommended design practices apply to a website that uses images for its main site navigation?

- **Answer:** c. Both a and b.
- *Explanation:* For accessibility and search engine optimization (SEO), screen readers need alternative text (alt attribute) for visual menus, and text links at the footer serve as an excellent fallback mechanism.

5. Which of the following is a color scheme that consists of two colors that are opposite each other on the color wheel?

- **Answer:** b. complementary
- *Explanation:* Complementary color schemes utilize opposites on the color wheel (such as blue and orange) to create high visual energy and distinct contrast.
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PART 2

This section reviews and compares **CNN** (*cnn.com*) and **MSNBC** (*msnbc.com*), two leading digital news platforms that target identical global audiences, focusing on how they implement the four core design principles: **CRAP (Contrast, Repetition, Alignment, Proximity)**.

1. Contrast

- **CNN:** Uses high-contrast typography, presenting bold, heavy black headings against a clean white background. Crucial or breaking news is immediately isolated using a bright red accent color, forcing the user's eye to focus on high-priority headlines.
- **MSNBC:** Also relies on dark text against a white canvas but emphasizes its brand color (dark blue) for headings and navigational highlights. MSNBC tends to use lighter, subtle gray borders to separate distinct editorial columns, creating a slightly softer visual contrast compared to CNN's sharp grid lines.

2. Repetition

- **CNN:** Exhibits strict consistency throughout its page layout. The global navigation bar remains locked at the top, utilizing the same font family (CNN Sans) across all articles. The red "Breaking News" badge is structurally repeated to create a familiar sense of urgency.
- **MSNBC:** Repeats its brand's core color palette throughout the entire interface. Content blocks share identical padding, borders, and image aspect ratios. This consistency helps the user effortlessly predict where information will appear as they navigate deeper into various news sections.

3. Proximity

- **CNN:** Groups related news components closely together. For example, a main story's thumbnail image, headline, publication timestamp, and short summary are packaged tightly within a single visual grid box. This close grouping clearly informs the user that these elements belong to the same article.
- **MSNBC:** Successfully implements proximity in its multimedia video sections. Video thumbnails, title descriptions, and "Play" buttons are structurally tied together. White space is utilized effectively to separate different categories (e.g., Politics vs. Business), preventing the dense news layout from feeling overcrowded.

4. Alignment

- **CNN:** Follows a highly structured, strict multi-column grid alignment. Text blocks are consistently left-aligned for optimal reading patterns (F-shaped reading flow). The main structural blocks align perfectly along invisible vertical axes, giving the platform a polished, authoritative digital newspaper aesthetic.
- **MSNBC:** Employs a robust structural grid system that keeps elements mathematically aligned across the desktop view. Horizontal card layouts line up seamlessly at the top and bottom edges, establishing a cohesive and symmetrical visual harmony that makes browsing through vast amounts of real-time data highly intuitive.